

The Culture of Business, Finance and the Economy

Class 22 – 4 june

Dr. Juan M. del Nido
First semester 2026

Recap

The invention of "Corporate Culture"

New Vogue: Company Culture

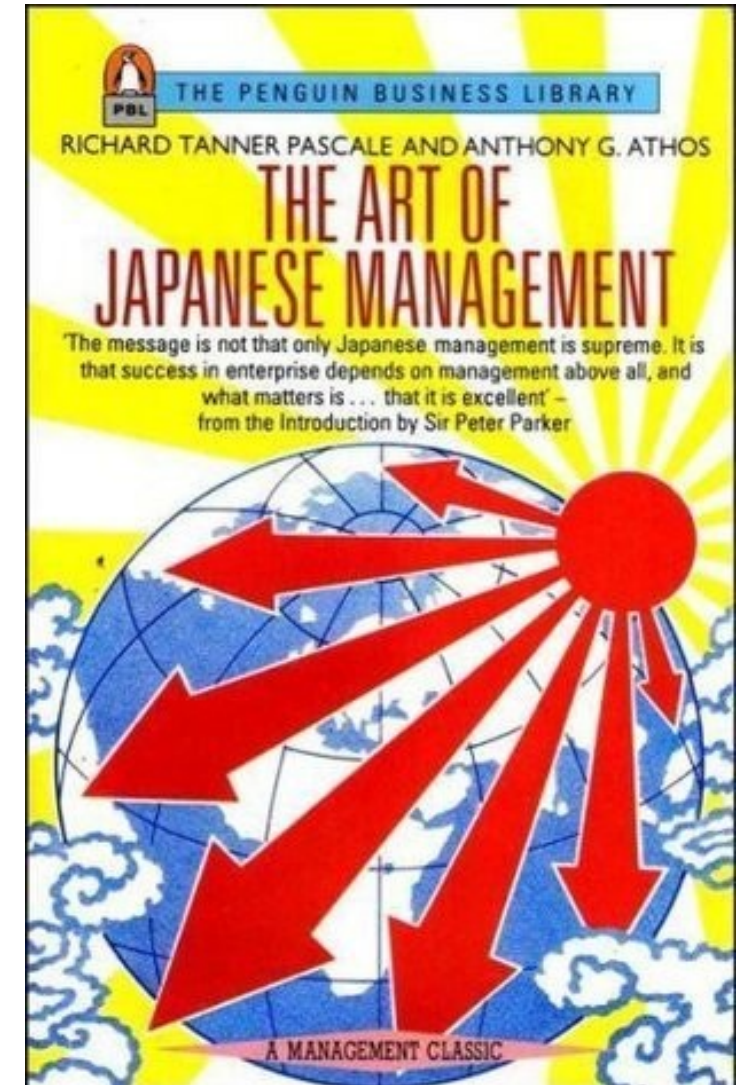
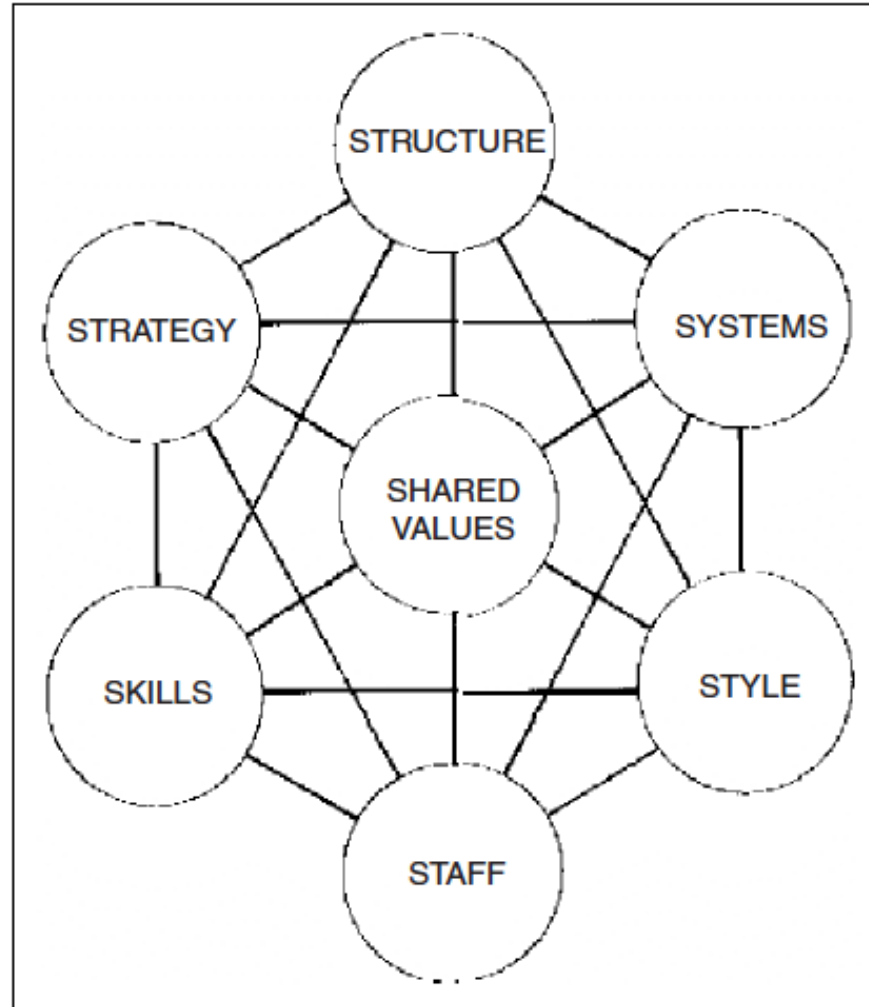
For decades, and increasingly, there has been a growing emphasis on the importance of company culture. This emphasis has been fueled by a number of factors, including the success of companies like Google and Microsoft, which have attributed their success to a strong corporate culture. The concept of corporate culture has become a buzzword in the business world, and many companies are now investing in building a strong corporate culture.

One of the most common definitions of corporate culture is "the set of values, beliefs, and behaviors that characterize an organization." This definition is broad and encompasses a wide range of factors, from the way employees interact with each other to the way the organization interacts with its customers. Corporate culture can be a powerful force for good, helping to create a positive work environment and fostering innovation and creativity. However, it can also be a source of problems if it is not managed properly.

One of the most common problems with corporate culture is that it can be too rigid. If a company's culture is too inflexible, it can stifle innovation and creativity. Employees may feel that they are not allowed to think for themselves or to challenge the status quo. This can lead to a lack of motivation and a decline in productivity. On the other hand, if a company's culture is too loose, it can lead to a lack of direction and a decline in quality. Employees may not know what is expected of them, and they may not feel that they are part of a team.

Building a strong corporate culture is a complex task that requires a lot of time and effort. It is not something that can be done overnight. Companies need to invest in training and development programs to help employees understand the company's values and behaviors. They also need to create a positive work environment where employees feel valued and respected. Finally, they need to be consistent in their actions and behaviors, so that employees can see the company's values and behaviors in action.

Despite the challenges, building a strong corporate culture is worth the effort. It can be a powerful force for good, helping to create a positive work environment and fostering innovation and creativity. It can also be a source of competitive advantage, helping a company to stand out from its competitors. In the end, a strong corporate culture is what makes a company truly great.



Today

Corporate Social Responsibility

tories and reports



2025 Water Stewardship Project Portfolio

Replenish and Watershed Health projects as of the end of 2024



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Speeches

CARLY FIORINA
BUSINESS FOR SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY ANNUAL CONFERENCE
LOS ANGELES, CALIFORNIA
NOVEMBER 12, 2003

One of the most influential articles in the history of business schools (is) Milton Friedman's work entitled: "The Social Responsibility of Business is to Increase its Profits," (arguing) that business leaders had no responsibilities other than to maximize profits for the shareholders.

We live in an age where those attitudes have begun to change; in an age when hundreds of employees and top executives will take time out of their busy schedules to meet here, for example, to discuss the idea of corporate social responsibility.

We live in an increasingly transparent age where every nook and cranny of a company is increasingly exposed for the entire world to see.

Our website, for example, will tell you about the e-inclusion campaign that we have underway in communities as far away and diverse as India, or South Africa, or East Palo Alto—on-the-ground efforts that are working to close the gap between technology-enabled and technology-excluded communities, while we develop new products, and new customers, and new employees in the process.

There are four reasons why we're doing these things. The first is that it is simply the right thing to do. We live in a world today where half the population lives on two dollars a day; where one billion people cannot read or write; where a billion and a-half people never get a clean glass of water. And if **none of these people ever feel part of the global economy, do any of us really believe that it is sustainable for the long term for any of us?**

The second reason to do it is that the global movement to enforce labor, and environmental, and economic standards is clearly picking up steam, and **we as companies still have the ability to shape that movement and to take control of that movement before it takes control of us.** This movement can only grow stronger, and **we can sit back and wait to be regulated in ways that we might not like very much, or we can take control of these issues for ourselves,** and by doing so, bring **more predictability and more sustainability,** and hopefully in some cases, **better solutions** to a chaotic world.

The third good reason to do this is that shareowners and customers are rewarding companies that achieve social change through business. Will investors actually seek out companies that do the right thing? The numbers suggest the answer is yes.

And finally, the fourth good reason is enlightened self-interest. I believe corporate social responsibility is good for the top line and good for the bottom line; it is not just the right thing to do, it is the smart thing to do.

CSR proponents promote voluntary self-regulation as opposed to mandatory national or transnational forms of regulation. The industry has produced a proliferation of corporate and trade association codes of conduct, transnational standards, social auditing bodies and accreditation mechanisms, and socioenvironmental principles for financing,

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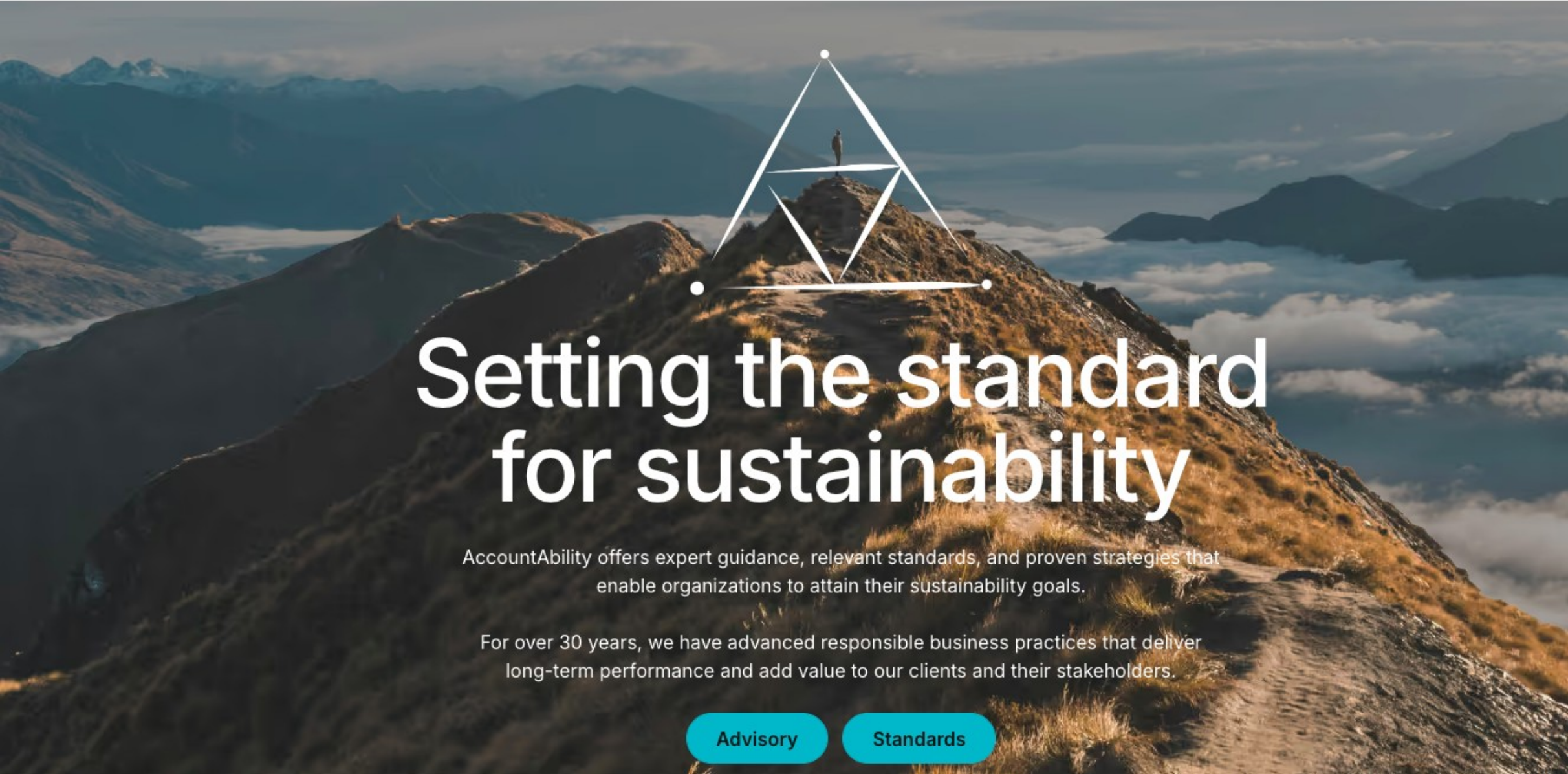
ISO 14000 family

Environmental management

For companies and organizations of any type that require practical tools to manage their environmental responsibilities, there's the ISO 14000 family.

International Standards on environmental management provide tools for a strategic approach to environmental issues. The best-known such standard is [ISO 14001, setting out the criteria for an environmental management system \(EMS\)](#).

Together with a set of supporting documents it forms the ISO 14000 family of standards.



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The UN Global Compact, a landmark CSR institution launched in 2000 to promote universal principles of human rights, labor, the environment, and anticorruption for businesses, allows member companies to enhance their reputation with no mechanisms for accountability. Global Compact signatory companies monitor and report on their own adherence to the principles; there are no significant policing mechanisms or punitive sanctions for violating the principles. In debates over voluntary mechanisms, states are demoted to simply individual players in a multistakeholder process that purports to accord equal footing to governments, corporations, communities, and civil



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About the UN Global Compact

We are a voluntary initiative based on CEO commitments to implement universal sustainability principles and to take steps to support UN goals.

[OUR GOVERNANCE](#)

**They're doing it because it makes
economic sense**

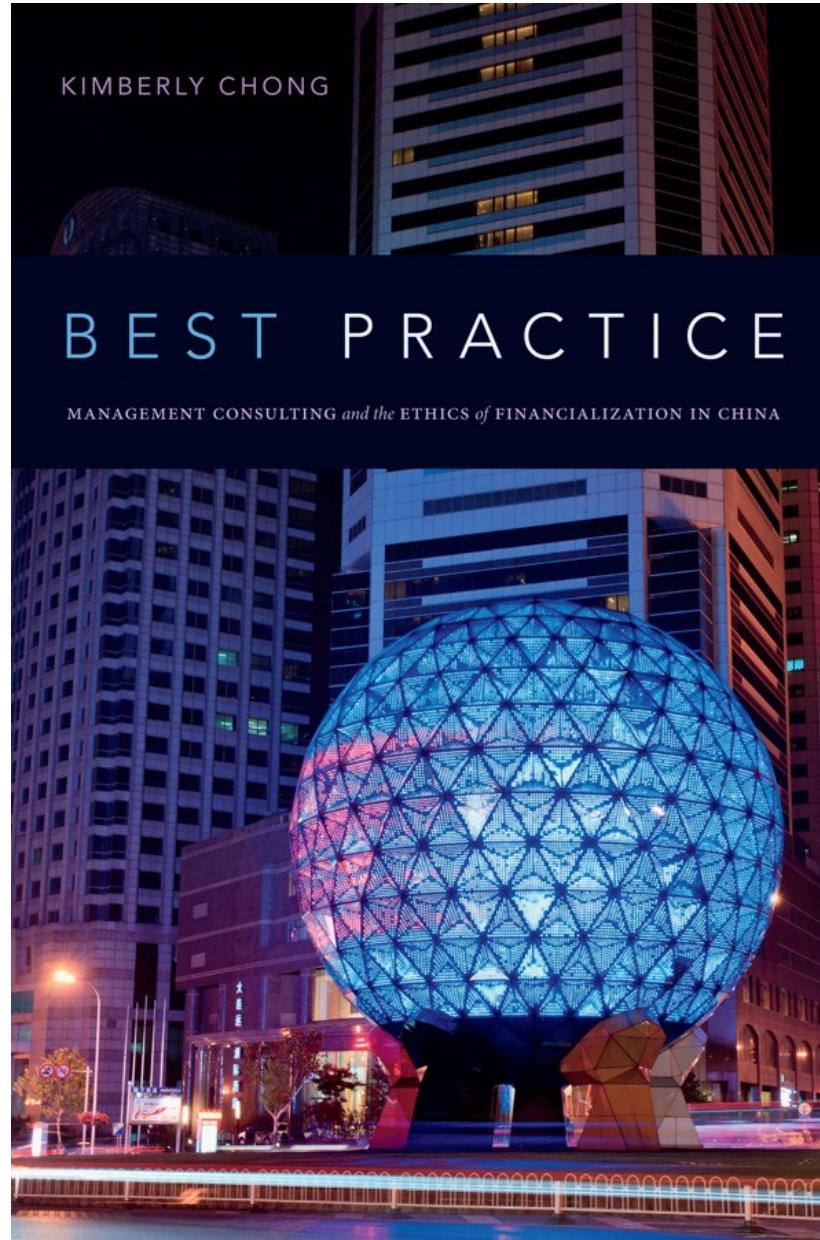
But also

**They're doing it because it makes
economic sense**

Example 1: turning workers into certain kinds of subjects. 2008 Sichuan, China



Systemo's CSR: 5-day bike ride



“Experiences of suffering, hardship, and dislocation are part of an enactment of morality in which employees are asked to relate to a “safe” other to which they can direct their goodwill”

CSR expands economic value to subsume moral and social values, making engaged employees attuned to the values of the company and to the position it wishes to put forward. Employees become a ‘community’, by turning labor and other economic relations into a question of employees’ loyalty, engagement with values, readiness to display virtue.

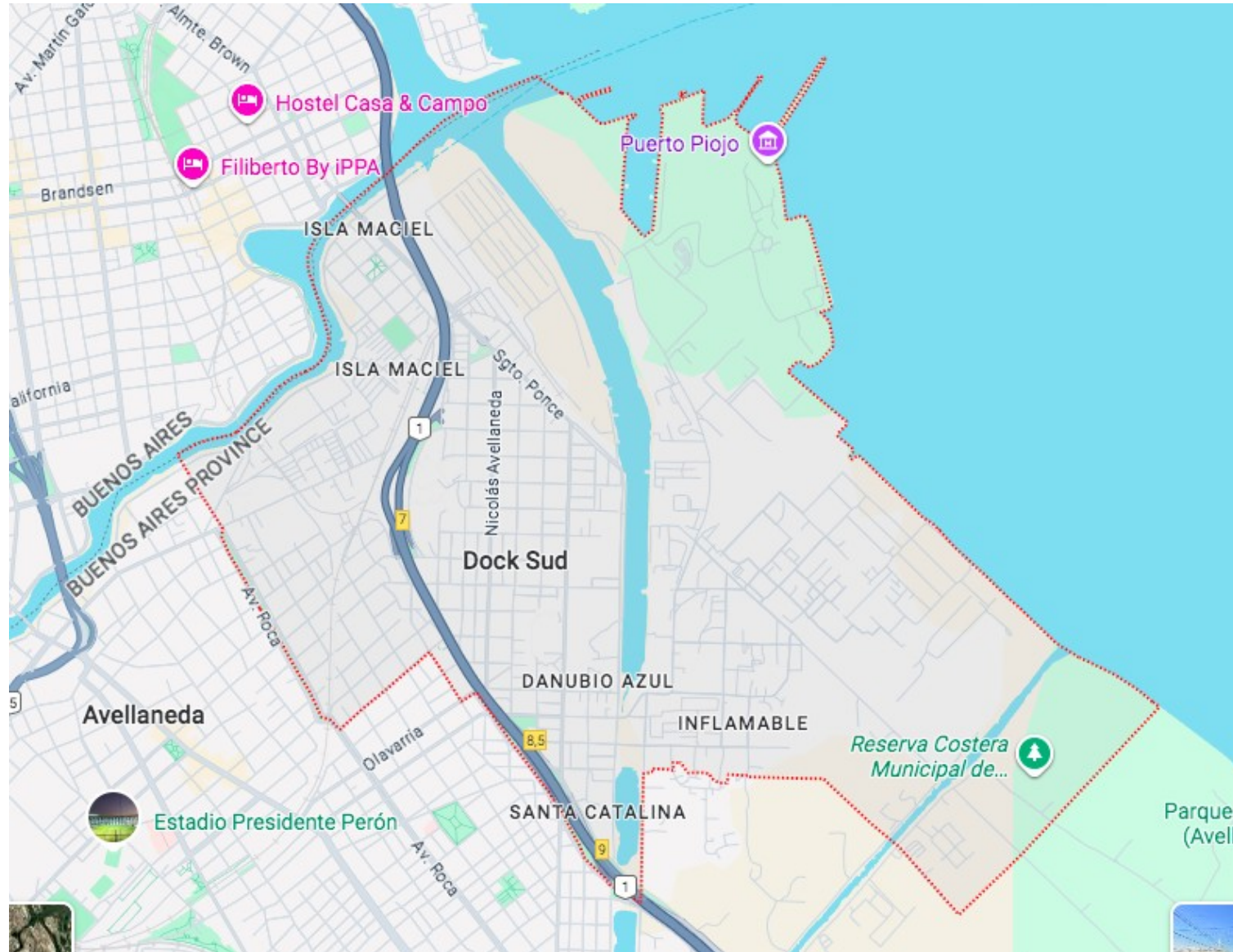
The message that we needed to suffer to do good, that this was an exercise in being “outside your comfort zone,” was deeply apparent. Given that these workers spend at least five days a week inside an office, cycling 150 kilometers across Sichuan was physically and mentally challenging. But these were isolated, contained challenges. Unlike the children they visited, the recipients did not stay in makeshift housing, but rather at a four-star hotel. Similarly eating simple dishes of plain vegetables and rice was a one-off experience of “the local,” not a mundane aspect of everyday existence. These were also meticulously planned challenges; by contrast, the children were faced with the ongoing instability, uncertainty, and precarity of living in the aftermath of the earthquake.

The children eating scraps of food, carrying sacks of sticks on their back, hands and faces raw from the cold, had been identified as the deserving subject of charity. Through these stark inequalities and parallels – the children were Chinese like the office workers and they laughed, ate and played games together for a while - CSR initiatives gain their moral legitimacy. In these differences and parallels emerges a “zone of virtue” where employees *experience* as a series of revelatory moments—about their own capabilities, their responses to adversity, their position in social hierarchies, and even the utility of their expertise – that are sought after inside the company in terms of CSR.

Later on ...

“Amelia, the U.S. lead, said she would only want the U.S. offices to be involved if we could “deliver a high-level experience that rivals the Everest event.” The year before, employees were invited to “challenge themselves” by trekking to the Mount Everest base camp, an event of great complexity to organize, and which was collectively judged a “resounding success.” I was struck immediately by Amelia’s emphasis on the individual employee’s experience rather than the charities for which the employees would be raising money”

Example 2.1: appeasing the locals. Shell and Dock Sud







RESOURCES FOR REFORM

OIL AND NEOLIBERALISM
IN ARGENTINA

ELANA SHEVER

**Shell's CSR program has helped create a
"license to operate" in Argentina: like
elsewhere CSR provides the mechanisms for
corporations, and oil companies in
particular, to claim social permission to
continue to work in a socially exploitative
and environmentally destructive fashion**

Punteros and Manzaneras: grassroots leaders and punteros and manzaneras provided food, medical care, construction materials, and other items in neighbourhood community centers



The Shell representative who met with these leaders was the plant's security manager. His responsibilities included supervising the refinery facilities and maintaining the company's relationship with the people living on the other side of the barbed wire fence: a space of insecurity to monitor. He delivered (used) computers to the municipal hospital, fire extinguishers to local schools, and propane canisters to soup kitchens. His role expanded to include meetings with punteros and piqueteros and offer cash.

These cash handouts and material donations were part of the company's effort to make sure that the petrochemical complex was safe from Dock Sud: these donations and social programs are above all important **security measures.**

“It always ended up that Shell arranged with a couple of (them) from Dock Sud on our behalf, so that we would shut up and [go] each to his house.” She further explained that Shell’s “custom” was to offer local organizations money in the name of “paternal sponsorship” (padrinazgo). In this way, Shell “begins to absorb them, and . . . Those centers and those people become managed by Shell.”

It was less expensive for them to donate food and medicine to the communal soup kitchens than to switch to more environmentally sound technologies

Shell cerró con éxito su campaña por 1 millón de platos de comida saludable



Concluyó de forma exitosa la iniciativa solidaria “Juntos para Ayudar” de Raízen Argentina – licenciataria de la marca Shell – mediante la cual se donaron un millón de platos de comida con ingredientes nutritivos destinados a más de 300 comedores comunitarios en distintos puntos del país, con el objetivo de promover la alimentación saludable y sustentable en familias de



Example 2.2: “empowering” locals to shift risk and responsibility. Shell in Dock Sud



Shell nurtured a new relationship with Dock Sud residents by training them to meet their own needs by using a discourse and techniques of “empowerment.” “they would not only be asking for things, but also offering what they know how to do and the resources that they might have.”

Company officials taught that Shell was a friendly and caring neighbor who was concerned about its neighbors’ well-being yet wanted to foster their independence. As a group of grantees and I learned during a training session, empowerment meant providing many hours of unpaid “volunteer” labor. Shell only provided funds for purchasing material supplies and for compensating outside experts, not for paying local residents who did the organizations’ daily work or who provided occasional labor.

The community's demand that Shell offer employment at the refineries to more area residents was translated into a pledge to encourage entrepreneurial income-generating opportunities in "the local community" and thus outside of the petrochemical complex. Whereas Shell previously had built a neighborhood health clinic, it now awarded grants to NGOs to provide health education. The program redefined "community needs" in ways that placed their solutions outside of the refinery walls.

Shell mostly funded health and environmental education activities that taught that people were responsible for the health of their own bodies and those of their children. One program instructed mothers in the shanty settlements to avoid pollution by drinking bottled water and by keeping their children from playing on the ground. The company framed people as autonomous individuals who could control what entered their bodies and the environment around them (...) thus shifting the burden of illness from the industries that produce toxins onto those who ostensibly “elect” to place themselves and their families in a contaminated environment.

Example 3: a de facto state role. Sumbawa, Indonesia



AMMAN MINERAL NUSA TENGGARA (AMNT)

AMMAN

Amman Mineral Nusa Tenggara (AMNT) operates the Batu Hijau mine, a significant open-pit copper and gold operation. We produce high-grade, exceptionally clean copper concentrate enriched with gold and silver

AMNT also conducts exploration activities in Elang Deposit, one of the world's largest undeveloped porphyry copper and gold deposits

A crucial feature of CSR is its intimate ties to the development industry. The relation between the corporations and development agencies has multiple dimensions, from the revolving door between the two spheres (and government) to extensive partnerships and a growing belief that corporations alone have the power to catalyze development. The development–CSR relationship is particularly close in mining, oil, and certain extractive industries because companies operating in remote regions often assume a de facto state role, subsidizing public transportation, education, health, utilities, and waste management infrastructure.

After the arrival of Newmont, village elites moved to establish business ventures supplying the mine and its contractors with transportation services, housing, temporary labor crews, construction materials, and agricultural goods. Further, they created new nongovernmental organizations (NGOs) that fell somewhere between private profit seeking and community development institutions.

They incited social conflicts they themselves were strategically placed to resolve as a means of forcing Newmont to extend its affirmative action policies (for local hiring and business contracts) and channel its community development commitments (e.g., providing microcredit, agricultural supplies, and public health, education, irrigation, and transportation infrastructure) through local companies and NGOs. Mine managers calculated they could lose at least one million dollars a day if roadblocks halted production.

In time, the mine began sustaining life in this remote corner of Indonesia like the state would: providing all infrastructure, security, pensions, policing, schooling and so on. This means, in turn, that CSR activities have consolidated a kind of de facto state sovereignty over those people and that territory.

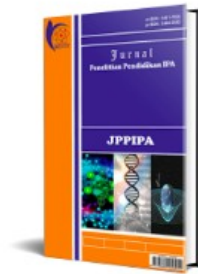
(also)

Program pencegahan stunting Stunting prevention programs



Stunting masih menjadi masalah yang signifikan di kalangan anak-anak Indonesia. Stunting menyebabkan konsekuensi jangka panjang seperti gangguan perkembangan fisik dan mental, kesehatan yang buruk, dan berkurangnya produktivitas di masa dewasa. Sejak tahun 2022, kami telah berkolaborasi dengan Badan Kependudukan dan Keluarga Berencana Nasional (BKKBN) dan Yayasan Care Peduli untuk memerangi stunting di sekitar Batu Hijau. Program ini berfokus pada peningkatan akses terhadap makanan bergizi selama masa kehamilan, masa bayi, dan masa kanak-kanak, serta memberdayakan para perempuan untuk membuat keputusan pengeluaran keluarga yang tepat dengan memprioritaskan nutrisi.

Stunting remains a significant issue among Indonesian children, leading to long-term consequences such as impaired physical and mental development, poor health, and reduced productivity in adulthood. Since 2022, we have collaborated with the National Population and Family Planning Agency (Badan Kependudukan dan Keluarga Berencana Nasional/BKKBN) and Yayasan Care Peduli to combat stunting near Batu Hijau. The program focuses on improving access to nutritious food during pregnancy, infancy, and early childhood, while empowering women to make informed family spending decisions to prioritize nutrition.



Identification of Mercury Content in Children Stunting Patients Aged 0–24 Months in the Regions Small Scale Gold Mine in Krueng Sabee District, Aceh Jaya Regency

Lensoni , Ambia Nurdin , Ismaturrahmi

DOI: 10.29303/jppipa.v9i9.5017

Published: 2023-09-25

Mercury is a type of heavy metal that is included in the category of Hazardous and Toxic Materials (B3) waste because it can harm living things and pollute the environment. Mining is known to be the largest contributor of mercury to the environment. Mercury exposure can harm the health of children, stunting growth. This study aims to identify mercury content in children stunting patients aged 0 - 24 months This study concluded that 88% of stunted toddlers were found to contain mercury that exceeded the threshold.

Example 4: CSR to reframe the conversation



The Keyword

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Product news ▾

Company news ▾

Feed



Our commitment to water stewardship

Sep 09, 2021 · 4 min read



Kate Brandt

Chief Sustainability Officer

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2025 Google Water Stewardship Project Portfolio

In 2021, we announced our goal to replenish 120% of the freshwater volume we consume, on average, across our offices and data centers by 2030, and help restore and improve the quality of water and health of ecosystems in the communities where we operate. This report provides an overview of the 112 projects in Google's water stewardship portfolio that are contributing to that goal as of the end of 2024.

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March 2025

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2025 Water Stewardship Project Portfolio

Replenish and Watershed Health projects as of the end of 2024



Bonus: NGOisation of relations: Walmart's "associates"

Here for life's unexpected turns —
because no associate should have to
face tough times alone.

ACNT
**Together
Fund**

The Associates in Critical Need Trust (ACNT) is a nonprofit that provides financial assistance to eligible Walmart associates who are having trouble covering their basic living expenses following an unexpected, unavoidable event. To help figure out if you might qualify, review the information below. If you think you might be eligible, search for Together Fund on [One.Walmart.com](https://www.walmart.com) to review the full eligibility guidelines.

What makes me eligible?



You're a full or part-time U.S. associate working for Walmart Inc. or its affiliates. Temporary or terminated associates are not eligible.



You've worked with Walmart for at least 90 days.



You meet the financial need and event requirements. See below and on [One.Walmart.com](https://www.one.walmart.com).



The reason you need financial help has to have happened within the last year, during the time you've worked at Walmart.

What are the financial need and event requirements?

Financial Need

- You'll need to be prepared to report your monthly household income and expenses.
- You'll also need to report how much money you have in savings.

Event Categories

- Major illness, injury or death
- Unexpected household situation
- Involuntary loss of, or damage to, housing or transportation
- Unexpected unemployment

A close-up photograph of a woman with dark hair smiling and holding a baby. The woman is wearing a blue top, and the baby is wearing a yellow shirt. The background is blurred, showing other people in a crowd.

In 2004, WAL-MART Employees gave
OVER \$5 MILLION
to help fellow workers.

The Walton Family gave \$6,000

Conclusion